

Southpaw Hurlers Head Miner Roster

It could be a pitching lineup of southpaws Friday and Saturday when the Texas Miners open their 1969 baseball season at Dudley Field against the University of Albuquerque Dons.

Coach Andy Cohen's Miners, hopeful of getting a running start on their massive 49-game schedule, will meet the Dons in a single game Friday (2:30 p.m.) and a twin feature Saturday (1:30 p.m.).

Spring sports tickets, priced at \$15 for 30 events, will be honored at the game. The tickets are being sponsored by members of the school's ROTC department.

Cohen has not picked a definite pitching rotation for the Albuquerque series but it could easily be Lynn Hunt, Marc Bombard and Harry Milner, a trio of portsiders.

Hunt, the ace of Cohen's staff for two years, was 7-4 a year ago for a team which came home with an 18-18 record. As a sophomore, the El Paso native was 8-3 with a sparkling 1.73 earned run average.

Bombard worked at San Angelo last season before the school sliced the sport from its athletic program. The 5-foot-8, 170 pounder is a native of El Paso.

Milner, from Kilgore, is a 5-foot-11, 190 pounder with great promise, according to Cohen. He is a transfer from Odessa JC.

Cohen has one bit of sad news from his pitching corps — the strongest part of his club, he says. Jesse Lujan, who dipped to 1-5 last season after an 8-1 record in 1967, has been pestered with arm trouble and may be of little use to the Miners for a period.

Despite Lujan's ailment, Cohen feels he still has good depth on the hill. Veterans Bill Disselhorst and Don Wilson return and so does lefty Terry Witt. Ron Jones, a big, strong righthanded football player, could be the big surprise package for Cohen's chunkers this season.

Jones, 6-foot-4 and 218, has

impressed Cohen with his work although he still has trouble with his control.

The hitting is the most questionable part of Cohen's club, which goes for the Western Athletic Conference southern division title this spring.

One of Cohen's main concerns is the lack of lefty hitting. Of the regulars, only first baseman Larry Currie swings from the south side of the platter. Addition of Currie in the lineup has forced Cohen to move John Miller, who stroked .348 last season, to the outfield.

Only Miller and second baseman Juan Sandoval (.311) of the regulars were above .300 last season. Cohen does expect some power from third baseman Danny Blanco, catcher Ron Hix and outfielder Mike Ward.

Import Rich Butler, a 5-foot-10, 190 pounder from Anthony, could also figure into Cohen's batting plans. Butler has made some progress since Cohen opened drills and the sophomore may be in the lineup during the Albuquerque series.

Willie McCovey of San Francisco led National League sluggers last season with a .545 mark.

